iii. Intercalating agents

Acridine, proflavin, ethidium bromide are examples few examples of intercalating agents. These insert (intercalate) themselves between adjacent bases in one or both strands of the DNA double helix. Due to this an extra base (chosen at random, G in the Figure 12.13a) must be inserted into the new DNA strand opposite the intercalating agent. Intercalating agents can cause either additions or deletions.

The Ames Test: A Screen for Potential Carcinogens

Everyday we are exposed to a wide variety of chemicals in our environment, such as drugs, cosmetics, food additives, pesticides, and industrial compounds. Many of these chemicals can have mutagenic effects,

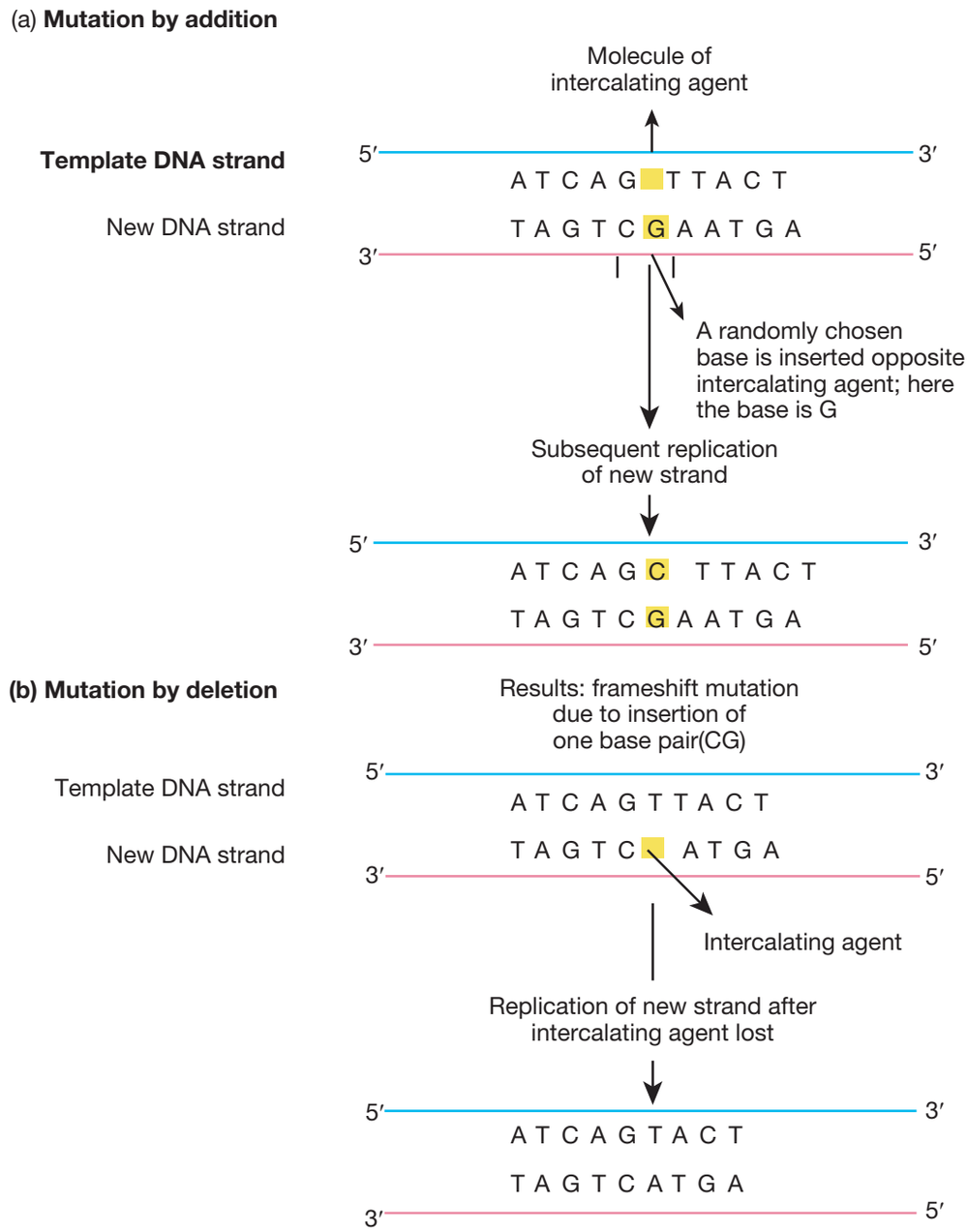


Figure 12.13: Mutations due to intercalating agents

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